Index-calculus baselines: the ratchet

Status (2026-10-15). This is the first edition of the ledger. It takes no new measurement: every number is copied from a committed experiment, and each row cites that experiment. The machine-readable twin is `baselines.json`; update both files in the same change.

The rule this file serves

AGENTS.md, "Success criterion: iterative improvement of the index-calculus baseline" (owner, 2026-10-15; cryptanalysis#919, crypto#1908):

- **The baseline** for a curve and size is the best current verified IC pipeline. It is frozen with its protocol, receipts and end-to-end cold `S`.
- **A success** is any verified, measured improvement over that baseline on the same instances, under a protocol frozen before timing. Advance and engineering both count. Relabelling and accounting are recorded and do not count.
- **The ratchet.** A landed improvement replaces the row here, and the old row moves to the history with its delta.
- **The gap** to the matched rho, and to Bernstein–Lange (BL) where it was measured, is the distance remaining. It is not a pass/fail gate. A claim to *beat* rho still needs every reference rule: a cold `S` below the matched rho's, robust at growing `n`, independently replayed.

How to read the numbers.

- **One row, one experiment.** No row combines numbers from two experiments. Where an experiment did not measure a quantity, the cell says so.
- **Every gap is IC cost over the reference's cost.** Above 1 is distance still to close; below 1 means the IC is cheaper on that boundary. The sources quote the online figure the other way up (rho over IC). That figure is kept in each JSON row's `source_figure`.
- **`S` = cost / $\sqrt{\mathbf{r}}$**, in the row's own unit. The unit differs between experiments, so compare `S` inside a row only. The gaps carry no unit.
- **Tuned rho** means rT770: A's tuned `StrongRhoG` (Fold field kernel, 64 lanes, DP 6, escape off). `koblitz-n83-reconcile-20261014` found it to be the fastest correct n=83 reference, but it has only been run at n=83. ParallelRho, inside crypto's `ic price`, is crypto's own signed-Frobenius walk (64 lanes in lockstep). It is the matched rho at n=41–61, but it is not rT770.

The baselines

n	curve	current best verified IC pipeline (commit; protocol)	targets	`S` cold / online (IC)	`S` cold / online (rho)	cold gap, IC / rho [95%]	online gap, IC / rho [95%]	gap to tuned rho (rT770)	gap to BL (online, IC / BL)	evidence tier	next improvement to try
19	E0 / GF(2^19), a=1	volcano-ic τ-orbit dim-6 base, Sage Gröbner (arm `tau6`); cryptanalysis `3f722e2e`; protocol.json of volcano-ic/ rho-arm-20261014; run 38520305068	10 planted scalars, each one complete ECDLP	5,154 / not separable	0.260 / —	**1.94e4** [1.69e4, 2.23e4] (CPU, geometric mean)	not measured: each IC run is cold	none; the matched rho is a signed-Frobenius walk at 0.997× the floor in steps, run in Python/Sage, not tuned for wall time	none	exploratory (GitHub VM, unpinned)	Move tau6's per-relation Gröbner solve out of Sage (native, or the subspace `PDP2ht` oracle); re-run against the same rho arm
41	K_0 / GF(2^41)	`ic price --single-target` at IC programme baseline v3: 6,560 points, 80 columns, aimed m=3 collection, m=2 pair-table descent; crypto `995ea207`; rule v3	64 public points, 1 process each, +4 A/A	11.17 / 0.121	1.459 / 1.318	**7.66** [6.90, 8.61]	0.092 [0.071, 0.116]	**none measured**: the matched rho is ParallelRho (0.56× the strong walk's ns/step); rT770 is frozen to run in koblitz-s23-tuned-rho-20261015 (see Open)	model only: 2.21	crypto isolated_bench container	Setup is 98.9% of cold `S`: cut the reusable setup at fixed recipe, as a new IC programme round against v3

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53	K_0 / GF(2^53)	same pipeline, 27,984 points, 264 columns; crypto `995ea207`; rule v3	64 + 4 A/A	16.98 / 0.058	1.282 / 1.236	**13.2** [11.8, 15.0]	0.047 [0.036, 0.059]	**none measured** (ParallelRho 0.53× strong)	model only: 1.77	crypto isolated_bench container	Setup is 99.7% of cold S: cut it at fixed recipe; then price the n=53 representative-plus-Frobenius orbit domain as its replacement
61	K_0 / GF(2^61)	same pipeline, 39,040 points, 320 columns; crypto `995ea207`; rule v3	64 + 4 A/A	24.93 / 0.079	1.189 / 1.168	**21.0** [18.6, 23.8]	0.067 [0.051, 0.088]	**none measured** (ParallelRho 0.50× strong)	model only: 3.52	crypto isolated_bench container	Setup is 99.7% of cold S, and the cold gap grows as r^0.18: cut the setup; price the compact-orbit K=500 producer on these 64 points
83	K_1 / GF(2^83)	B's `koblitz_orbit_dlp_fast_online` + `ic_log_cache.patch`, K600 (99,600 points, 600 orbit columns), S3 root index (candidate ID below); crypto `770f6a69`; `koblitz-n83-bl-arm-20261014/protocol.json` at cryptanalysis `507c1ec4`; run 38689817618 (**PR #918, not merged yet**)	B's 16 fresh public points + Q0 ×4	32.93 / 0.083 (rT770 steps)	0.091 / 0.082	**360** (no interval)	1.01 [0.30, 2.12], not separated	**measured on this row**: online not separated from parity, cold 360×	**measured: 235** [61, 645], 16/16 points BL faster; cold IC/BL 0.987 by construction	Tier 1 (GitHub runner, one pinned CPU)	The rank stage is 520.8 s of the 549.8 s precomputation (95% of cold S): replace it with the guided minimum-rank policy on K600, then re-run this BL protocol

Figure 1. The baseline rows' gaps on a log scale: cold and online to the matched rho, and online to Bernstein–Lange (measured at n=83, a model elsewhere). Each row is one experiment. Bars are 95% intervals where the source gives one (source, vector).

Curves and candidates.

n	curve ID	ICV1 slug	r	IC1 candidate of the baseline
19	`EC1N19Ckb1h01617b86df6c`	(volcano-ic surface curve E0)	130,873	none recorded
41	`EC1N41Ce0he09550ab560a`	`icv1-f2m41-tm2308219-7f48b14a`	549,756,390,943	`IC1N41Ckb0fb6560PDP3pairtableRCaimedLAsparseTDwalkISO0h5b25909970b3`
53	`EC1N53Ce0hb097de99be9a`	`icv1-f2m53-tm56619371-dac20a85`	21,044,858,204,113	`IC1N53Ckb0fb27984PDP3pairtableRCaimedLAsparseTDwalkISO0h715dd7692112`
61	`EC1N61Ce0hd8c15448081e`	`icv1-f2m61-t158598901-ab42b6c5`	162,888,033,982,417	`IC1N61Ckb0fb39040PDP3pairtableRCaimedLAsparseTDwalkISO0he9352435e473`
83	`EC1N83Ce1h35c7ced6b497`	`icv1-f2m83-t6151469093347-9eba6cd5`	8,569,786,107,849,059	`IC1N83Ckb1fb99600PDP4s3rootindexRCguidedLAdenseTDsingleISO0hc0ecc1fffbd7`

Notes on the rows.

- **n=19.** The S unit is one rho group operation of CPU time (2.17e-5 s). The IC's cold S is the τ6 arm's CPU per ECDLP in that unit. The baseline subspace base reads 1.77e5× rho in the same run. τ6 over the baseline base is 9.12 [8.12, 10.27].
- **n=41–61.** The unit is one batched affine addition, measured in each row's own process. v3's unit is 2.3–3.2× cheaper than §23's, so S is not compared across the two (rule v3 README). Every row passes `validate_claim` at `vs_rho` (68/68 per size). Both certificates were replayed outside the process, and the logarithms equal §23's.
- **n=83.** S is derived inside the one run: wall ms divided by that run's measured rT770 step (180.8 ns) and by $\sqrt{r}$. Cold is the matched precomputation P_IC (520,825 ms rank stage + 29,022 ms per-process setup) plus the mean online time. BL's precomputation was matched to P_IC in wall time on the same CPU, so the cold IC/BL ratio is 0.987 by construction. The baseline is this experiment, not the merged reconcile run, because it is the one experiment that measures the tuned rho, BL and cold together. If PR #918 changes, this row changes with it.

Other verified records

These rows are kept for context and as the history behind the baselines. None is combined with another row.

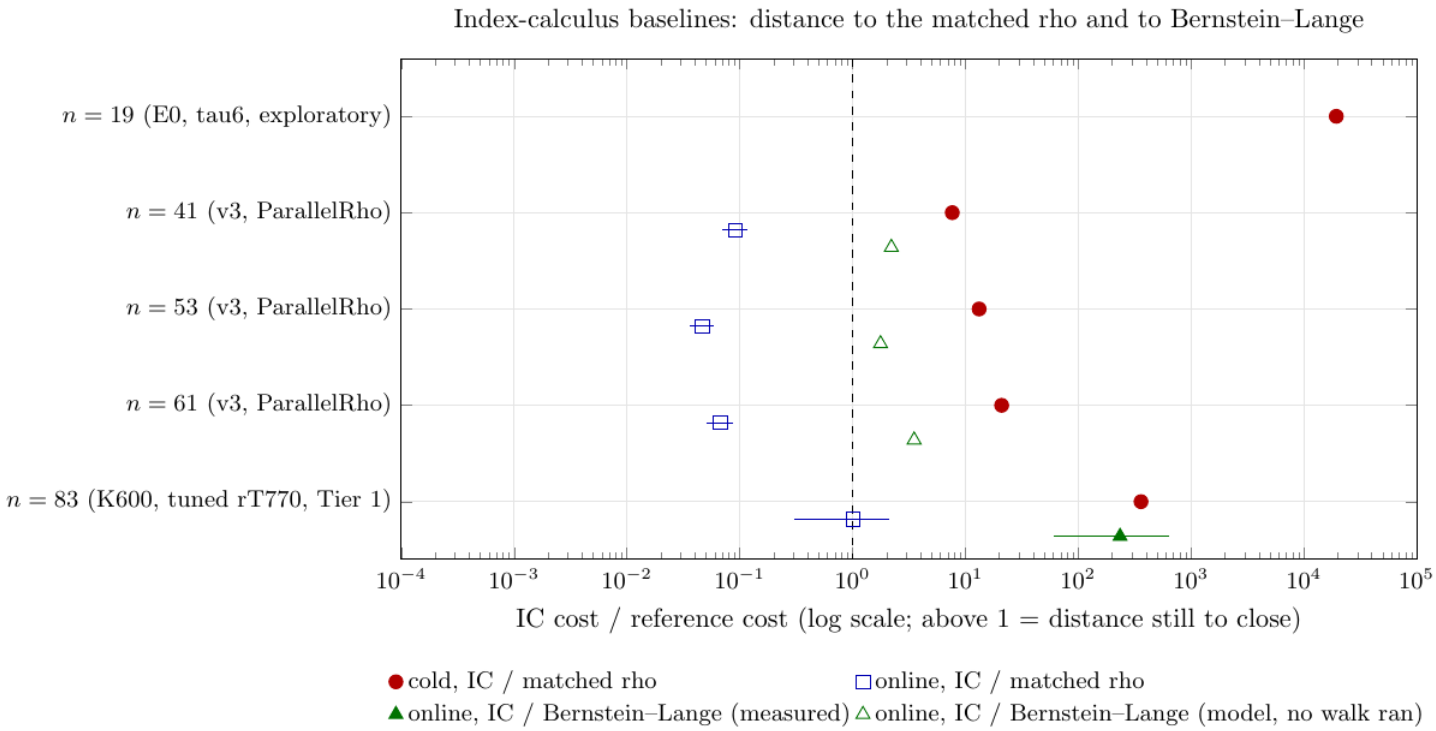


Figure 1: Distance to the matched rho and to Bernstein–Lange, per baseline row.

n	role	experiment	reference	cold gap, IC / ref [95%]	online gap, IC / ref [95%]	BL	tier
41	previous baseline (v0)	ledger §23, crypto `0bf67f16`	ParallelRho, same process	8.04 [7.26, 9.01]	0.107 [0.082, 0.135]	model 2.50	crypto isolated_bench container
53	previous baseline (v0)	ledger §23	ParallelRho	14.7 [13.1, 16.7]	0.057 [0.044, 0.073]	model 2.02	same
61	previous baseline (v0)	ledger §23	ParallelRho	31.6 [28.2, 35.7]	0.113 [0.084, 0.148]	model 8.04	same
41	other pipeline, complete cold CPU	crypto `disjoint_cold_v2_outcome_20261001` (run 36803331080), compact-orbit K85	32-walk signed-Frobenius normal-basis rho (not rT770)	13.4 [9.37, 18.5]	not measured	none	hosted, A/A and quiet-host gates, second-host replay
53	other pipeline, complete cold CPU	same, compact-orbit K220	same	22.7 [17.9, 31.6]	not measured	none	same
61	other pipeline	crypto autolab run `20261012T202048Z-5521627904`, compact-orbit K=500	strong rho rung 3 (not rT770)	83.4 (median of rows)	0.072 [0.052, 0.102] (inverse of median 13.94)	none	taskset-pinned container with a CPU-isolation receipt
83	same pipeline as the baseline (merged)	`koblitz-n83-reconcile-20261014`, run 38617911080	rT770, two seeds per point	313 (fresh-rank setup)	0.92 [0.28, 1.78], not separated	none	Tier 1
83	same pipeline, first Tier 1 run	`koblitz-single-target-n83-tier1-20261014`, run 38523707244	rung 3, slower per step than StrongRhoG, so not the matched tuned rho	134	0.36 [0.11, 0.66]	model 33.5 (measured later: 235)	Tier 1

Ratchet history

n	from	to	cold gap	online gap	class
41	§23 (v0, `0bf67f16`)	rule v3 (`995ea207`)	8.04 → 7.66	0.107 → 0.092	engineering (IC programme rounds R03, R05, R07)
53	§23 (v0)	rule v3	14.7 → 13.2	0.057 → 0.047	engineering
61	§23 (v0)	rule v3	31.6 → 21.0	0.113 → 0.067	engineering

The paired cold-time ratios between baselines, each in its own runs, are in crypto `research/notes/index-calculus/IC_TOOL_PROGRAM.md` §7. The gaps above are each against that comparison's own rho, and that rho also changed between §23 and v3. So the gap delta is the distance remaining, not the IC's own speedup.

Stage results: canonicalization

Stage improvements are recorded here. One becomes a pipeline improvement only once it moves an end-to-end `S` above.

stage	n	experiment	result	tier	pipeline effect
normal-basis least rotation, isolated	131	`canon-n131-20261014`	Five exact canonicalizers on `[u64; 3]`. Ir per uniform word: lift_scan 514, gap_scan 1,435, exhaustive 1,850, exhaustive_bf 3,664, refine_bf 4,510. 0 mismatches.	deterministic Ir; wall times exploratory	none yet
the same, inside a decomposition-style loop	131	`canon-n131-loop-20261014`, run 38607684318	lift_scan is fastest on all four workloads: 16/16 contrasts at Bonferroni, ratios 1.83–3.81. In-loop Ir over the loop floor: lift_scan 519, gap_scan 1,760, exhaustive 2,883.	Tier 1 for the timing	none yet. No n=131 pipeline exists, and at n=53 the isolated ranking did not survive the loop (`papers/frobenius-orbits` §4/§7)

Open

- **n=41, 53, 61:** the gap to rT770 is unmeasured. `experiments/koblitz-s23-tuned-rho-20261015` (branch `claude/ic-s23-tuned-rho`) is frozen to measure it. It uses the v3 pipeline on §23's 64 points per size, against rT770 and the default `StrongRhoG`.

- **n=19 and n=41–61:** no Bernstein–Lange walk has run, so the BL figures are models or absent.
- **n=83:** the baseline's experiment is on PR #918, which is not merged yet.
- **n=19:** there is no IC1 candidate manifest, and online `S` is not separable.

Updating this file

1. Freeze a protocol for the candidate improvement against the row's pipeline, on the same instances, before timing.
2. When the improvement lands, replace the row in `baselines.json` and in the table above. Add a history row with the before and after figures and the class (advance, engineering, relabelling, accounting). Relabelling and accounting do not replace a baseline.
3. Name the next improvement to try in the new row.
4. Re-render Figure 1 and this file's PDF:

```
cd docs/ic/figures && pdflatex baselines_gap.tex && pdftoppm -png -r 160 -singlefile baselines_gap.pdf baselines_gap
cd .. && pandoc BASELINES.md -o BASELINES.pdf --pdf-engine=pdflatex -H pdf-header.tex -V geometry:landscape,margin=1.2cm -V fontsize=9pt
python3 -m json.tool baselines.json > /dev/null
```

Sources

- crypto `docs/ic/BOUNDARY_TARGETS.md` and `docs/ic/boundary_targets.json` (Regime B `vs_rho`; complete cold compact-orbit panel).
- crypto `research/notes/index-calculus/RESEARCH_IC_BOUNDARY_LEDGER.md` §23; `research/ic_single_target_20260930/` (PROTOCOL, analysis.json).
- crypto `research/ic_tool_program/rule/v3/` (README, PROTOCOL, analysis.json); `research/notes/index-calculus/IC_TOOL_PROGRAM.md` §7.
- crypto `research/notes/ecc2k130/disjoint_cold_v2_outcome_20261001/RESULT.md`.
- cryptanalysis `experiments/koblitz-n83-bl-arm-20261014/` (branch `claude/n83-bl-arm`, PR #918): README, `run_github_38689817618/result.json`.
- cryptanalysis `experiments/koblitz-n83-reconcile-20261014/`: README, `run_github_38617911080/panel/result.json`.
- cryptanalysis `experiments/koblitz-single-target-n83-tier1-20261014/`: README, `tier1_github_38523707244/`.
- cryptanalysis `experiments/volcano-ic/rho-arm-20261014/`: README, `results/summary.json`.
- cryptanalysis `experiments/canon-n131-20261014/` and `experiments/canon-n131-loop-20261014/`.